

Reviewing Ethical Behavior Expectations in the Faculty Handbook

Due to recent litigation, our faculty and student handbooks were reviewed with a fine-toothed comb and updated. The current handbook provides broad coverage and details for legal and ethical issues.

An area of specific importance in the handbook expresses that Latin's personnel standards are consistent with agreed-upon best practices. The Latin handbook states that the school holds many personnel standards and abides by the ISACS standards — this is the Independent School Association of the Central States. This commitment in the handbook shows the school's dedication to professionalism. By expressing alignment with a well-regarded organization, it holds Latin to the highest standards even if things are not explicitly stated in the handbook.

The issues of non-discrimination and transparency are very notable in the handbook. Clearly in the handbook, in that section, it states that “There is no discrimination against any person in admissions, employment, conditions of work, or otherwise that is in violation of the law.”

The non-discrimination policies are so detailed that they even get into the weeds about making accommodations for pregnant employees or those giving birth. Reasonable accommodations will be provided. There is an extensive section of the handbook that details pregnancy accommodations and state regulations, including accommodations for milk expression and lactation rooms.

Many other ethical issues are addressed in the handbook, such as:

- Anti-harassment Policy
- Sexual Harassment Policy
- Non-retaliation Policies
- Whistleblower Policies
- Conflict of Interest Policies
- Confidential Information Policies
- Trademark Policies
- Personal Information Privacy
- Social Media
- Online Fraternization Policies
- Non Solicitation Policies
- Mandated Reporter Policies
- Student-Faculty Relationships Policies
- Anti-nepotism Policy

All in all, the employee handbook that details ethical responsibilities is extremely thorough. If I were to make one change, I would create an abbreviated version that can also be used. Because the handbook is so thorough, it may not be able to highlight the most important ethical commitments to serve as everyday reminders to employees of the standards of account to which they are held.